

Letter of Commitment

To Whom it May Concern

Re: Dmitrii Lagovskii extradition to Russia

I, Ilya Yashin, make this statement at the request of Dmitrii Vladimirovich Lagovskii for use in proceedings concerning his possible extradition from Serbia to the Russian Federation.

I am a Russian opposition politician and a long-standing critic of Vladimir Putin's regime. I have been active for in Russian public life for over twenty years, including through election campaigns, public demonstrations, and campaigns in defence of human rights and against political repression. I was prosecuted and imprisoned in Russia for publicly opposing Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine. I spent more than two years in a Russian prison and was released in August 2024 as part of an international prisoner exchange. I now live in political exile in Germany.

I do not address the merits of the criminal case brought against Mr Lagovskii in Russia. My statement concerns the risks he would face if returned to Russia and placed in pre-trial detention.

Based on my personal experience of the Russian criminal-justice and penitentiary systems, and on my knowledge of current Russian practice since the start of the full-scale war against Ukraine, I believe that Mr Lagovskii would face serious and immediate risks if extradited to Russia.

First, the Russian judicial system is not independent. Criminal proceedings in Russia are routinely used for political and coercive purposes, including against persons who are regarded by the authorities as politically unreliable, disloyal, anti-war, or otherwise inconvenient. Since February 2022, the Russian authorities have greatly expanded the use of criminal law to suppress dissent, anti-war expression and perceived disloyalty. Charges formally presented as ordinary criminal or security offences may, in practice, be used to exert pressure, secure compliance, or punish refusal to cooperate with the authorities.

Second, Russian pre-trial detention facilities are now part of the system used to recruit men for the war against Ukraine. In my experience and understanding, detention in a Russian pre-trial detention facility places a person under the practical control of investigators, prison staff, operational officers and other authorities who may exert pressure outside any meaningful legal safeguards. Since the war began, detainees and prisoners have been pressured to sign contracts with the Ministry of Defence and to join Russian forces fighting in Ukraine. This practice has become widespread and systematic, and I am personally familiar with it from my experience of imprisonment in Russia.

Third, detainees and prisoners may be subjected to threats, violence, psychological pressure, worsening of detention conditions, and threats of new or more serious charges in order to force them to sign military contracts. A person held in pre-trial detention is especially vulnerable because he is isolated from public scrutiny, dependent on prison staff and investigators, and has very limited practical ability to resist unlawful pressure.

Mr Lagovskii's personal circumstances make these risks especially acute.

I understand that Mr Lagovskii was born in Ukraine, refuses to fight against Ukraine, previously served in the Russian armed forces, and has a military communications / radio-engineering background. These factors make him a particularly valuable and vulnerable target for coercive recruitment. His Ukrainian origin makes the danger even more acute. If Mr Lagovskii is forced to choose between signing a military contract and refusing to fight against the country where he was born, I believe the consequences of refusal would be especially severe. In that situation, he would face a real risk of violence, retaliation, and the fabrication or aggravation of charges against him.

I am also informed that Russian police and military-enlistment officials have already sought to use the criminal case against Mr Lagovskii as leverage: his relatives and persons at his registered address in Russia have reportedly been told that the criminal case may be "closed" if he agrees to go to the so-called "special military operation", and that if he refuses he will be found and imprisoned. This is consistent with the current practice I have described. It is also precisely the kind of pressure that may become much more severe once a person is physically in Russian custody.

In my view, if Mr Lagovskii is extradited to Russia, he will almost certainly be detained on arrival. Once in a Russian pre-trial detention facility, he would be exposed to a serious risk of coercion to sign a military contract, ill-treatment if he refuses, and possible deployment to the war against Ukraine if the pressure succeeds. These risks arise from the current functioning of the Russian criminal-justice and penitentiary systems in wartime conditions. They are not theoretical

For these reasons, I believe that Mr Lagovskii's extradition to Russia would expose him to a serious risk to his liberty, physical integrity, and life.

I make this statement in good faith, based on my personal experience, public knowledge of current Russian practice, and the information provided to me about Mr Lagovskii's case.

Respectfully,

Ilya Yashin

Berlin, Germany

30.05.2026

A handwritten signature in black ink, consisting of a large, stylized 'S' followed by a vertical line and a series of loops and strokes that form the letters 'IYA'.